YouTube High-CTR Thumbnail Science & Retention Scripting Pla

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1. The Mathematics of Click-Through Rate (CTR)

- Thumbnail Contrast Physics: High dynamic range, clear foreground focal points, and maximum 3-word text overlays.
- Title Frameworks: Curiosity Gap vs Direct Benefit. "I Built a $10k AI App in 48 Hours" vs "How to Use AI".
- Mobile Feed Preview: Test your thumbnail at 120px width to ensure readability on smartphone screens.

2. The First 30 Seconds Retention Rule

- Hook Immediately: Validate the thumbnail promise in the first 5 seconds; never start with a generic animated logo.
- Micro-Cliffhangers: Introduce an unanswered question or benchmark result that resolves at the climax of the video.
- Pattern Interrupts: Change camera angle, on-screen text, sound effect, or B-roll every 7-10 seconds to maintain focus.